

Business Requirements Document

Grant Pathway — Version 1

Document Control

Field	Detail
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Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
0.1	2026-04-13	Rapidglobe Ltd	Initial draft
0.2	2026-05-07	Rapidglobe Ltd	AI delivery mechanism changed from Anthropic direct API (US) to Amazon Bedrock Claude Sonnet 4.6 (eu-west-2, In-Region). Data residency updated: UK primary, EU/EEA Geo fallback. Anthropic DPA/SCCs replaced by AWS Data Processing Addendum. Sections 2.2, 5, 11, 13, 14, 15, and Appendix C updated for consistency.

Related Documents

Document	Location
Decision Records Index	business/decisions/DECISIONS-INDEX.md
Vision Statement	business/vision-statement.md
Out of Scope Statement	business/v1-out-of-scope.md
Constraints & Assumptions	business/constraints-and-assumptions.md
User Personas, Journeys & Use Cases	business/user-personas-journeys-and-use-cases.md
Non-Functional Requirements	business/non-functional-requirements.md
Technology Stack	business/technology-stack.md
App Name & Branding	business/app-name-and-branding.md
Future Phases	business/future-phases.md

Document	Location
BRD Information Gathering Checklist	business/BRD-Information-Gathering.xlsx

1. Executive Summary

Grant Pathway is a free, AI-assisted grant writing tool built for UK charities. It is designed to reduce the time, effort, and expertise required to write a strong grant application — enabling volunteers and non-specialist staff to produce clearer, more consistent applications without professional fundraising support.

The service is offered entirely free of charge. It is built and initially operated by an individual developer, with the intention of transferring ownership to a Community Interest Company once the product is established and funded.

Version 1 delivers two core AI capabilities — guideline summarisation and draft answer generation — wrapped in a structured workflow that requires human review and approval before any AI-generated content can be used. The app does not submit applications on behalf of charities, does not guarantee funding outcomes, and does not search for or recommend grants.

Grant Pathway is targeted at small and mid-size UK charities where grant writing falls to volunteers or generalist staff with no dedicated fundraising resource. The primary beneficiaries are the charities and the communities they serve.

The target launch date is 31 July 2026.

2. Business Context & Problem Statement

2.1 The Problem

UK charities rely heavily on grant funding, yet the process of applying for grants places a disproportionate burden on small organisations. Unlike larger charities with dedicated fundraising teams, small and mid-size charities typically rely on volunteers or generalist staff to write applications — people with deep knowledge of their work but little or no training in grant writing.

The consequences are significant:

- Applications are written from scratch for every grant, even when large portions of content are the same
- Funder language — theory of change, additionality, outcomes frameworks — creates confusion and anxiety for non-specialists
- Each application consumes days of volunteer time that could be spent on frontline activity
- Application quality is inconsistent, reducing the likelihood of success
- Charities with excellent work and genuine need lose out to better-resourced organisations with professional fundraisers

There is no free, accessible tool that directly addresses the writing burden for this audience. Existing AI tools are generic and require technical confidence to use effectively. Professional grant writing services are unaffordable for small charities. The gap is real, material, and addressable.

2.2 The Opportunity

Advances in large language model (LLM) capability — specifically Anthropic Claude, accessed via Amazon Bedrock — now make it possible to build a structured, guided writing tool that:

- Summarises funder guidelines in plain English
- Generates tailored draft answers using the charity's own information
- Enforces human review before content is used
- Builds a reusable charity profile that saves time across multiple applications

Delivered free of charge, such a tool could meaningfully improve the capacity of thousands of small UK charities to compete for grant funding.

3. Vision & Objectives

3.1 Vision Statement

To be the trusted, free writing companion for UK charities — helping non-specialists produce stronger, more consistent grant applications through AI-powered drafting, guideline summarisation, and mandatory human review.

3.2 Objectives for v1

Ref	Objective	Measure
OBJ-01	Launch a stable, accessible web application by 31 July 2026	Live deployment by target date
OBJ-02	Enable any UK charity to register and complete an application within a single session	Confirmed through user testing
OBJ-03	Reduce the time a non-specialist spends writing a grant application	Evidenced through user feedback interviews
OBJ-04	Achieve WCAG 2.2 Level AA accessibility from day one	Internal testing and checklist review pre-launch
OBJ-05	Operate within a monthly running cost of £100	Monthly cost monitoring
OBJ-06	Gather sufficient early user feedback to inform v2 planning	Feedback interviews with opted-in users post-launch

3.3 Definition of Success at Launch

Grant Pathway v1 will be considered successful if: - The application is live, stable, and accessible - At least one charity completes a full application through the tool in the first month - Returning users are observed (indicating the tool is genuinely useful) - No material data protection incidents occur - Running costs remain within the £100/month budget

4. Scope

4.1 In Scope for v1

#	Capability
1	User registration, login, and account management
2	Charity profile creation with Charity Commission API lookup
3	Grant application creation and management (create, save, edit, delete, export)
4	Funder guideline input (paste or file upload)
5	AI-powered plain-English summarisation of funder guidelines
6	AI-powered draft answer generation for application questions
7	Mandatory human review and approval step for all AI-generated content
8	Export of approved content to Word (.docx) and plain text (.txt)
9	Full account and data deletion by the user
10	WCAG 2.2 Level AA accessibility
11	UK-region data hosting
12	Basic passive usage metrics (registrations, applications created, returning users)
13	Opt-in feedback interview consent at registration

4.2 Explicitly Out of Scope for v1

#	Item	Notes
1	Grant discovery	Deferred to future phase (DR-PS-002)
2	Grant eligibility matching	Depends on grant database; deferred (DR-AI-001)
3	Grant tracking and pipeline management	Out of scope (DR-PS-001)
4	Post-grant impact reporting	May be considered in future phase (DR-PS-001)
5	EU and international grants	UK only (DR-PS-003)
6	Live grant database	No 360Giving, GrantNav, or other integration (DR-IN-002)
7	CRM and accounting integrations	Manual entry only (DR-IN-001)
8	Open-ended AI chat	Structured, form-driven AI only (DR-AI-001)
9	Automated AI output validation	Human review is the sole validation mechanism
10	Native mobile application	Responsive web only (C16)
11	Multi-region data hosting	UK region only (C13)
12	Full document store	Guidelines are not permanently stored
13	Formal feedback and survey infrastructure	User interviews only (DR-SM-001)
14	CIC formation	Post-launch (DR-OD-001)

#	Item	Notes
15	Liability insurance	Post-CIC (DR-LC-002)
16	Independent accessibility audit	Pre-scaling milestone (DR-LC-003)

4.3 Future Phases Summary

Phase	Description
v2 — Grant Discovery	Help charities find relevant grants using 360Giving integration
Post-launch	CIC formation and operational funding
Post-launch	Structured satisfaction survey and feedback framework
Pre-scaling	Independent accessibility audit
Post-CIC	Liability insurance review

5. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role	Interest
Individual developer (Rapidglobe Ltd)	Builder and operator	Delivers the app; absorbs running costs until CIC is established
UK charities (primary users)	End users	Reduce grant writing burden; improve application quality

Stakeholder	Role	Interest
Charity volunteers and non-specialist staff	Direct users of the app	Save time; reduce anxiety; produce better applications
Amazon Web Services (AWS)	AI and infrastructure provider	Bedrock Claude model access (eu-west-2); data residency and compliance
Charity Commission for England and Wales	Data source	Charity register API for verification at onboarding
Future CIC	Long-term owner and operator	Continuity and sustainability of the service
Successor organisation (informal)	Contingency owner	Named informally before launch as continuity fallback
Sector funders (e.g. Nominet, Catalyst)	Potential CIC funders	Evidence of impact to unlock operational funding

6. User Personas

Two primary personas are defined for v1. Both reflect the primary user type established in decision record DR-TU-001 (volunteer or non-specialist) and the target charity size in DR-TU-002 (small and mid-size).

6.1 Persona 1 — Margaret, the Volunteer Grant Writer

"I spend a whole weekend writing one application and still don't know if I've answered it properly."

Field	Detail
Role	Volunteer, 1–2 days per week
Charity type	Small community wellbeing charity
Income band	Under £100k
Location	Market town, North of England
Age	58
Fundraising training	None
Technical environment	Personal Windows laptop; Google Chrome; no prior AI tool experience

Pain points: Starts from scratch every time; confused by funder jargon; each application takes 2–3 days; low confidence in quality.

Goals: Submit more applications in less time; build reusable content; feel confident the output is funder-appropriate.

6.2 Persona 2 — David, the Overloaded Charity Manager

"I end up writing applications at the weekend because there's no one else to do it, and I always feel like I'm reinventing the wheel."

Field	Detail
Role	Charity Manager / Operations Manager
Charity type	Youth services and early intervention charity

Field	Detail
Income band	£250k–£600k
Location	Urban, Midlands
Age	44
Fundraising training	Largely self-taught; one CPD course
Technical environment	Work Windows laptop; Chrome and Edge; has used ChatGPT

Pain points: Adapts same content repeatedly for different funders; inconsistency across applications; no time to improve quality.

Goals: Reduce time per application; achieve consistent language; submit stronger applications.

6.3 Secondary Persona — Priya (Future Phase Reference)

Priya is a part-time administrator at a small disability charity (£180k income) who has been asked to take on grant writing with no prior experience. She represents users who are less experienced than Margaret. The app should not exclude her, but v1 is designed around Margaret and David.

7. User Journeys

7.1 Journey 1 — First-Time User (Margaret)

Margaret has found a local grant and is using the app for the first time.

Step	Stage	Action	Outcome
1	Discovery	Sees app link in CVS newsletter	Lands on the app
2	Registration	Enters name, email, password	Account created
3	Feedback opt-in	Opts in to a feedback interview	Consent recorded
4	Charity lookup	Enters registered charity number	Charity Commission data pre-filled
5	Profile completion	Adds mission, beneficiaries, activities	Profile saved
6	New application	Enters grant name and funder	Application record created
7	Guidelines input	Pastes funder guidelines text	Guidelines ready for processing
8	AI summarisation	Clicks Summarise	Plain-English summary of funder priorities and questions
9	Question drafting	Selects a question; clicks Generate Draft	Tailored draft answer produced
10	Review step	Reviews draft against three prompts	Content checked
11	Edit and approve	Edits one sentence; clicks Approve	Content marked as approved
12	Save progress	Saves and closes	Application preserved
13	Return	Logs in next day; continues	Resumes from dashboard

Step	Stage	Action	Outcome
14	Export	Exports to Word	Clean document downloaded

Outcome: Margaret submits a stronger application in approximately half her usual time.

7.2 Journey 2 — Returning User (David)

David has used the app before. His charity profile is already complete.

Step	Stage	Action	Outcome
1	Login	Logs in	Directed to dashboard
2	Dashboard	Views existing applications	Previous work visible
3	New application	Starts new application	Profile auto-populated — no re-entry needed
4	Guidelines upload	Uploads PDF	Guidelines ready
5	AI summarisation	Receives summary	Funder priorities identified
6	Batch drafting	Works through questions systematically	Drafts generated quickly
7	Consistency	Notes consistent mission language	Same phrasing as previous application
8	Save for later	Saves and closes	Progress preserved

Step	Stage	Action	Outcome
9	Return and complete	Finishes remaining questions	All content approved
10	Export	Exports to Word	Pastes into funder portal

Outcome: David completes an application in approximately 4 hours instead of a full weekend.

8. Use Cases

Ref	Use Case	Actor	Summary
UC-01	Register Account	New user	Create account with email verification
UC-02	Opt In to Feedback Interviews	New user	Record consent to feedback contact at registration
UC-03	Look Up Charity via Charity Commission API	Registered user	Pre-fill profile from Charity Commission register
UC-04	Complete Charity Profile	Registered user	Enter full organisational profile
UC-05	Start a New Grant Application	Registered user	Create a new application record
UC-06	Input Funder Guidelines	Registered user	Paste or upload funder guidelines

Ref	Use Case	Actor	Summary
UC-07	Generate AI Summary of Funder Guidelines	Registered user	Receive plain-English funder summary
UC-08	Generate Draft Answer for an Application Question	Registered user	Receive AI-drafted answer for a question
UC-09	Review and Approve AI-Generated Content	Registered user	Mandatory review before content is saved
UC-10	Edit Application Content	Registered user	Edit draft text directly before approving
UC-11	Save Application Progress	Registered user	Save application state; resume later
UC-12	Return to a Saved Application	Registered user	Resume a previously saved application
UC-13	Export Application Content	Registered user	Download approved content as Word or plain text
UC-14	Update Charity Profile	Registered user	Edit profile fields; updates apply to future applications
UC-15	Delete Account and All Data	Registered user	Permanently delete account and all associated data

Full use case detail (preconditions, main flows, alternative flows, postconditions) is documented in `business/user-personas-journeys-and-use-cases.md`.

9. Functional Requirements

Functional requirements are numbered FR-01 onwards and are derived from the use cases in Section 8.

9.1 Authentication & Accounts

Ref	Requirement
FR-01	The system shall allow new users to register with their full name, email address, and a password
FR-02	The system shall validate email format and enforce a minimum password length of 10 characters at registration
FR-03	The system shall send a verification email upon registration; accounts shall not be activated until the email link is clicked
FR-04	The system shall allow registered users to log in with their email address and password
FR-05	The system shall provide a self-service password reset flow triggered by email
FR-06	The system shall automatically log out users after 60 minutes of inactivity
FR-07	The system shall provide optional multi-factor authentication (MFA) as an opt-in feature; MFA shall not be mandatory in v1
FR-08	During registration, the system shall present a plain-language prompt asking the user if they are willing to participate in a feedback interview; the response shall be recorded against the account

9.2 Charity Profile

Ref	Requirement
FR-09	Following account activation, the system shall prompt the user to enter their charity's registered number
FR-10	The system shall query the Charity Commission for England and Wales public API and pre-fill the charity name, registered address, date of registration, and charitable objects
FR-11	Where the Charity Commission API is unavailable or the charity is not found, the system shall allow the user to enter all charity details manually and shall display a plain-language explanation
FR-12	The charity profile shall include the following fields: registered charity number, charity name, registered address, charitable objects, mission narrative, beneficiary description, main activities and programmes, geographic area of operation, and annual income band
FR-13	The system shall allow users to update their charity profile at any time from their account settings
FR-14	The charity profile shall be used as an input to all AI-generated content to personalise outputs to the charity's context

9.3 Application Management

Ref	Requirement
FR-15	The system shall allow a user to create a new grant application by entering the grant name, funder name, and an optional application deadline
FR-16	The system shall display all saved applications on a user dashboard, showing the grant name, funder name, and the date last edited
FR-17	The system shall allow a user to open and continue any saved application from their dashboard

Ref	Requirement
FR-18	The system shall auto-save application progress at regular intervals; manual save shall also be available
FR-19	The system shall allow a user to delete a saved application
FR-20	A single user account shall support multiple saved applications simultaneously

9.4 Funder Guideline Handling

Ref	Requirement
FR-21	The system shall allow users to input funder guidelines by either pasting text directly or uploading a file in PDF or Microsoft Word format
FR-22	Funder guidelines shall be used for AI processing only and shall not be permanently stored after the application session
FR-23	The system shall display a plain-language error message if an unsupported file format is uploaded, and shall prompt the user to paste the text instead

9.5 AI Guideline Summarisation

Ref	Requirement
FR-24	On user request, the system shall generate a plain-English summary of the funder's guidelines covering: funder priorities, types of projects funded, eligible organisations, evidence expectations, and a plain-language explanation of each application question
FR-25	AI summarisation shall use both the funder guidelines and the charity profile as inputs to the Claude API

Ref	Requirement
FR-26	The system shall display a visible progress indicator while AI processing is underway
FR-27	In the event of an API error or timeout, the system shall display a plain-language error message and allow the user to retry

9.6 AI Draft Answer Generation

Ref	Requirement
FR-28	On user request, the system shall generate a draft answer for a selected application question
FR-29	Before generating a draft, the user shall be able to specify a word limit for the answer
FR-30	AI draft generation shall use the application question, word limit (if specified), funder summary, and charity profile as inputs to the Claude API
FR-31	If the generated draft significantly exceeds the specified word limit, the system shall flag this prominently to the user

9.7 Mandatory Review & Approval

Ref	Requirement
FR-32	Every AI-generated draft answer shall be presented alongside three plain-language review prompts: (1) Does this accurately describe your charity and project? (2) Are all figures, dates, and facts correct? (3) Does this answer the question that was asked?
FR-33	The system shall require explicit user approval before AI-generated content is saved to the application; this step cannot be bypassed

Ref	Requirement
FR-34	The user shall be able to edit the draft text directly within the review interface before approving
FR-35	The user shall be able to discard a generated draft and either regenerate a new draft or write their own answer
FR-36	Approved content shall be visually marked as approved and saved to the application record

9.8 Export

Ref	Requirement
FR-37	The system shall allow users to export all approved application content as a Microsoft Word (.docx) file
FR-38	The system shall allow users to export all approved application content as a plain text (.txt) file
FR-39	The system shall prevent export where no content has been approved, and shall display a prompt directing the user to complete at least one review step

9.9 Account Deletion

Ref	Requirement
FR-40	The system shall allow users to permanently delete their account from Account Settings
FR-41	Before deletion, the system shall display a plain-language warning explaining that all data will be permanently and irreversibly deleted

Ref	Requirement
FR-42	The user shall be required to confirm deletion by re-entering their email address
FR-43	On confirmation, the system shall permanently delete: the user account, charity profile, all saved applications, and all AI-generated content associated with that account
FR-44	The system shall send a confirmation email to the user once deletion is complete

10. Non-Functional Requirements

10.1 Performance

Metric	Target
Page loads and navigation	Under 3 seconds
AI guideline summarisation	Under 30 seconds
AI draft answer generation	Under 60 seconds

10.2 Availability

Metric	Target
Uptime	99.5%
Maximum annual downtime	~44 hours

10.3 Scalability

Phase	Expected Concurrent Users
At launch	~10
At scale (12–18 months)	~100

10.4 Security

Control	Requirement
Encryption in transit	TLS 1.2 or higher; HTTPS enforced across all pages and API calls
Encryption at rest	Database-level encryption enabled on all data stores
Passwords	Minimum 10 characters; no mandatory complexity rules (NCSC guidance)
MFA	Available as opt-in; not mandatory in v1
Session timeout	Automatic logout after 60 minutes of inactivity
Security baseline	OWASP Top 10
Secrets management	No credentials or API keys committed to the public repository

10.5 Browser & Device Support

Category	Supported
Desktop browsers	Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari (latest 2 versions each)

Category	Supported
Mobile browsers	Chrome on Android; Safari on iOS
Minimum screen width	320px — fully responsive
Internet Explorer	Not supported

10.6 Accessibility

- The application shall meet **WCAG 2.2 Level AA** from day one
- Accessibility is a design-in requirement, not a post-build retrofit
- Testing approach: automated scanning (axe DevTools / Lighthouse), keyboard-only navigation testing, screen reader testing (NVDA + Chrome), manual WCAG 2.2 AA checklist review pre-launch
- An independent third-party accessibility audit is deferred to a pre-scaling milestone

11. Technology Stack

Concern	Technology
Language	TypeScript
Framework	Next.js
Database	PostgreSQL via Supabase (London region)
Authentication	Supabase Auth

Concern	Technology
File storage	Supabase Storage (London region)
Application hosting	Vercel
AI API	Anthropic Claude Sonnet 4.6 via Amazon Bedrock (eu-west-2)
Charity register	Charity Commission for England and Wales public API
Source control	GitHub (public repository — MIT licence)
Development environment	VS Code
Domain	Grantpathway.org.uk

Hosting and data residency: All charity data is stored exclusively in Supabase (London region), satisfying the UK-region data storage requirement (C13). The application layer is hosted on Vercel's global edge network; no persistent data is held at the application layer. AI processing uses Amazon Bedrock Claude Sonnet 4.6 in eu-west-2 (London) In-Region; in the event of a capacity or availability issue, Bedrock Geo EU routing may process data within up to 7 AWS regions, all within the EEA and covered by UK adequacy decisions. This arrangement will be disclosed in the Privacy Policy.

Fallback: If the UK data residency interpretation requires the compute layer to also be UK-hosted, AWS eu-west-2 (London) is the alternative for the Next.js application hosting.

12. Branding

Element	Decision
Official product name	Grant Pathway
Working title (retired)	AI Grant Accelerator
Domain	Grantpathway.org.uk

Colour Palette

Role	Colour	Hex
Primary	Deep teal	#0D6E6E
Primary light	Soft teal	#E6F4F4
Accent	Warm amber	#D97706
Success	Muted green	#16A34A
Neutral dark	Slate	#1E293B
Neutral light	Off-white	#F8F AFC
White	White	#FFFFFF

Typography

Role	Font	Weight	Minimum Size
Headings	Inter	Bold (700)	20px
Sub-headings	Inter	Semi-bold (600)	16px
Body text	Inter	Regular (400)	16px
Labels & captions	Inter	Medium (500)	14px

Tone of Voice

Principle	In Practice
Plain English	"Here's a draft answer" not "AI-generated output"
Encouraging	Acknowledge the user is doing something valuable
Honest	Clear that this is a starting point requiring review
Respectful	Non-patronising; charities know their work
Concise	Short sentences; active voice; no padding

13. Constraints & Assumptions

13.1 Constraints

Ref	Constraint	Description	Implication for v1
C1	Monthly running cost budget	Maximum £100/month personally absorbed before CIC is established	Feature scope or usage limits must be reviewed if costs approach this threshold
C2	Target launch date	31 July 2026	BRD completed May 2026; two weeks reserved pre-launch for compliance checks
C3	UK-only coverage	Limited to UK charities and UK grant applications	Content and terminology must reflect the UK grant landscape only
C4	Single developer	Built and maintained by one developer	Feature scope and timeline must remain realistic for a solo build
C5	Free access model	Free of charge to all eligible UK charities; no subscriptions or freemium tiers	No payment infrastructure required in v1
C6	Writing-only focus	Grant writing tool only; discovery deferred	Charities must already know which grant they are applying for
C7	No live grant data	No integration with external grant databases	No 360Giving, GrantNav, or Funding Central dependency
C8	Limited integrations	Charity Commission register only; no CRM or finance system links	All charity information beyond basic registration data is entered manually
C9	AI capability limits	AI limited to text generation and document summarisation only	No eligibility matching, open-ended chat, or automated validation
C10	Mandatory human review	All AI-generated content must be reviewed and approved before use	The review step is enforced and cannot be bypassed

Ref	Constraint	Description	Implication for v1
C11	No liability for AI content	Service acts as a writing aid only	Terms of Service must state the app does not guarantee funding, does not submit applications, and makes no representations to funders
C12	No AI training use	Charity data will never be used to train any AI model	Covered by the Amazon Bedrock service terms (no training on customer data); must be stated in the Privacy Policy
C13	UK-region data hosting	All app data stored in UK-region infrastructure; AI processing in UK/EEA via Amazon Bedrock	Primary AI processing in eu-west-2 (London); EU/EEA Geo fallback covered by UK adequacy decisions — no data leaves UK/EEA
C14	Regulatory compliance	Must comply with UK GDPR, DPA 2018, and Charity Commission guidance	Compliance in place before launch
C15	Accessibility standard	WCAG 2.2 Level AA from day one	Independent audit deferred to pre-scaling
C16	Web application only	No native mobile app	Must be responsive and usable on mobile browsers
C17	MIT open source licence	Codebase released under MIT licence	No secrets committed to the repository
C18	Open, documented codebase	Publicly hosted and documented for handover continuity	Named potential successor organisation identified informally before launch
C19	Defined sunset process	Minimum three months' notice, full data export, clean decommission if service must end	Last-resort fallback; primary plan is handover

Ref	Constraint	Description	Implication for v1
C20	Minimal metrics infrastructure	Basic passive usage metrics only via database counts	No analytics platform or survey tooling required

13.2 Assumptions

Ref	Assumption	Impact if Wrong
A1	Charity Commission API is freely available and stable	Alternative verification methods needed
A2	Anthropic Claude via Amazon Bedrock remains capable and available	Provider or usage model may need to change
A3	Amazon Bedrock Claude pricing remains stable within £100/month budget	Cost controls or usage limits may be needed
A4	Amazon Bedrock (eu-west-2 In-Region, EU Geo fallback) satisfies UK GDPR data residency requirements	Alternative AI provider or hosting configuration may be required
A5	Application content is organisational data, not personal data	Additional GDPR controls required if beneficiary personal data is included
A6	Target users have basic digital skills (email, web forms, copy-paste)	Core UX flows would need significant redesign
A7	Charities have already identified the grant before using the app	Core product scope would need to change
A8	Funder guidelines are accessible in a pasteable or uploadable format	Document handling would need to be redesigned

Ref	Assumption	Impact if Wrong
A9	Charities already hold the organisational, project, and budget information needed	Onboarding flow and AI quality would be significantly affected
A10	All information is entered manually by the charity	Integration scope would need to expand
A11	Users will genuinely engage with the mandatory review step	Review UX and liability position may need revisiting
A12	Charities place high value on data ownership and no-AI-training commitments	Adoption may be significantly lower without prominent data ownership assurances
A13	Early usage volumes stay within the £100/month constraint	Cost controls or usage limits would need to be introduced
A14	The charity sector will adopt a free tool with minimal onboarding friction	A more formal onboarding or endorsement route may be needed
A15	Basic metrics (registrations, applications, returning users) are sufficient initially	Analytics infrastructure may need to be brought forward
A16	Advanced metrics are appropriate for a later phase	A formal impact reporting requirement could accelerate this
A17	WCAG 2.2 AA is achievable in the chosen stack without specialist tooling	Stack selection may need to be revisited
A18	Charity Commission register is sufficient for basic charity verification	Additional verification methods may be needed
A19	CIC formation is achievable within a reasonable timeframe post-launch	Long-term ownership plan would need revisiting

Ref	Assumption	Impact if Wrong
A20	CIC operational funding will be available from sector funders once evidenced	A cost recovery or sustainability model would be needed
A21	Sufficient opted-in users will be available for feedback interviews	Alternative feedback mechanisms would need to be introduced sooner

14. Compliance & Legal

14.1 Data Protection & UK GDPR

Grant Pathway must comply with the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018. Key obligations include:

Obligation	How it is met in v1
Lawful basis for processing	Legitimate interests and/or contract performance (to be confirmed in Privacy Policy)
Data minimisation	Only data necessary for the service is collected
Storage limitation	Data is retained only as long as the account is active; full deletion on account closure
Right to erasure	Full account and data deletion available at any time (FR-40 to FR-44)
Data subject rights	Accessible via account settings and contact

Obligation	How it is met in v1
International transfers	AI processing via Amazon Bedrock occurs in UK/EEA (eu-west-2 primary, EU Geo fallback); no transfer outside UK/EEA occurs; no SCCs required — see 14.2
Privacy Policy	Must be published before launch; must cover data storage, hosting arrangement, and no-AI-training commitment

14.2 AI Data Processing — Amazon Bedrock (*Item 44 — Updated*)

Grant Pathway uses Anthropic Claude Sonnet 4.6 accessed via Amazon Bedrock (eu-west-2, In-Region). This means AI processing occurs within the UK (AWS London region) as the primary configuration. In the event of a capacity or availability issue, Amazon Bedrock Geo EU routing may process data within up to 7 AWS regions, all of which are within the EEA and covered by UK adequacy decisions. Data is never transferred to Anthropic's servers directly and does not leave the UK/EEA. No Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs) are required.

The AWS Customer Agreement and AWS Data Processing Addendum (DPA) govern the Bedrock arrangement and satisfy UK GDPR obligations. Amazon Bedrock's service terms confirm that customer data is not used to train foundation models.

Pre-launch action: Confirm that the applicable AWS Data Processing Addendum covers the Amazon Bedrock use case and satisfies UK GDPR obligations before 31 July 2026.

Status: Architecture confirmed (DR-AI-002, DR-DP-002 — revised 2026-05-07). AWS DPA review to be completed prior to launch.

14.3 Terms of Service (*Item 45 — To Be Drafted*)

A Terms of Service document must be published before launch. At minimum it must include the following statements, as established in DR-LC-002:

1. Grant Pathway does not guarantee or promise funding outcomes
2. Grant Pathway does not submit applications on behalf of charities
3. Grant Pathway makes no representations to funders on behalf of any charity

Status: To be drafted. Terms of Service to be published before 31 July 2026.

14.4 Privacy Policy (Item 46 — To Be Drafted)

A Privacy Policy must be published before launch covering:

- What data is collected and why
- Where data is stored (Supabase, London region)
- That application layer processing uses a global delivery network (Vercel)
- That AI processing uses Anthropic Claude Sonnet 4.6 via Amazon Bedrock (eu-west-2, London) as the primary configuration, with EU/EEA Geo fallback; data does not leave the UK/EEA
- That charity data will **never** be used to train, fine-tune, or improve any AI model — by the app operator or any third party including Anthropic
- How users can access, correct, and delete their data
- Retention periods

Status: To be drafted. Privacy Policy to be published before 31 July 2026.

14.5 Accessibility Compliance

The application must meet WCAG 2.2 Level AA before launch. The testing approach is defined in Section 10.6. An independent audit is deferred to a pre-scaling milestone (DR-LC-003).

15. Risks

Ref	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
R-01	Monthly running costs exceed £100	Medium	High	Monitor API usage from day one; implement usage monitoring; introduce rate limits if needed (C1, A13)
R-02	Charity Commission API is unavailable or deprecated	Low	Medium	Manual entry fallback built into the onboarding flow (FR-11, A1)
R-03	Amazon Bedrock Claude pricing increases significantly	Low	High	Monitor pricing; evaluate alternative providers or models if needed (A3, DR-AI-002)

Ref	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
R-04	AWS Bedrock arrangement does not satisfy UK GDPR requirements	Very Low	High	Review AWS DPA before launch; Bedrock eu-west-2 In-Region eliminates international transfer risk; EU Geo fallback covered by UK adequacy decisions (A4, DR-DP-002)
R-05	Users treat mandatory review as a click-through	Medium	Medium	Review UX designed to prompt genuine engagement; three specific prompts required (FR-32, A11)
R-06	Low adoption at launch	Medium	Medium	Free and frictionless; promoted via CVS newsletters and sector networks; no procurement barrier for small charities (A14)
R-07	Solo developer unavailability	Low	High	Open, documented codebase; named successor organisation identified informally before launch (C4, C18, DR-BM-002)
R-08	CIC formation delayed or not achieved	Medium	Medium	Sunset process defined with minimum three months' notice and full data export (C19, DR-BM-002)
R-09	Security vulnerability in open source codebase	Low	High	OWASP Top 10 baseline; no secrets committed to repository; monitored proactively (C17, NFR-04)
R-10	AI-generated content causes reputational harm	Low	Medium	Mandatory human review enforced; Terms of Service clearly limits liability; app described as writing aid only (C10, C11)

16. Future Phases & Roadmap

Phase	Item	Trigger
Post-launch	Grant discovery (v2)	Stable user base established; 360Giving integration evaluated (DR-PS-002, DR-IN-002)
Post-launch	CIC formation	After v1 launch and initial evidencing of impact (DR-OD-001)
Post-launch	Satisfaction survey and feedback framework	Once meaningful user base exists (DR-SM-001, DR-SM-002)
Post-launch	Operational funding bid	Once CIC established and usage data available (DR-OD-002)
Pre-scaling	Independent accessibility audit	Before the app scales significantly beyond early user base (DR-LC-003)
Post-CIC	Liability insurance review	When CIC is established (DR-LC-002)

Full detail on each deferred item is recorded in `business/future-phases.md`.

17. Appendices

Appendix A — Decision Records

All 28 business decision records are held in `business/decisions/`. The index is at `business/decisions/DECISIONS-INDEX.md`. Decisions cover: product scope, target users, ownership and distribution, AI capabilities, data protection, integrations, grant knowledge, success metrics, legal and compliance, build and maintenance.

Appendix B — BRD Information Gathering Checklist

The full checklist of 53 information items gathered prior to writing this BRD is held in `business/BRD-Information-Gathering.xlsx`.

Appendix C — Glossary

Term	Definition
AWS DPA	AWS Data Processing Addendum — the contractual document governing how Amazon Web Services (including Bedrock) processes customer data, and satisfying UK GDPR obligations
Charity Commission API	The public API provided by the Charity Commission for England and Wales, used to look up registered charity details
CIC	Community Interest Company — the intended long-term legal structure for owning and operating Grant Pathway
CVS	Council for Voluntary Service — local infrastructure bodies that support charities and voluntary organisations
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation; in this context, the UK GDPR as retained in UK law following the EU exit
LLM	Large Language Model — the type of AI model underpinning the Anthropic Claude API
NCSC	National Cyber Security Centre — source of UK password guidance referenced in NFR-04
OSCR	Office of the Scottish Charity Regulator — the charity register for Scotland, not covered by the Charity Commission API
OWASP Top 10	Open Worldwide Application Security Project's list of the ten most critical web application security risks
SCCs	Standard Contractual Clauses — contractual mechanisms used to legitimise international data transfers under UK GDPR
WCAG 2.2 AA	Web Content Accessibility Guidelines version 2.2, Level AA — the accessibility standard the app must meet

Term	Definition
360Giving	A charity that promotes open grant data; its GrantNav tool is the intended data source for the future grant discovery phase

Document status: Version 0.2 Draft Section 14 (Compliance) is partially outstanding pending AWS DPA review (item 44), Terms of Service drafting (item 45), and Privacy Policy drafting (item 46). Last updated: 2026-05-07